DRONA'S

CLOUD / DEVOPS + GATE 2027

Corrected Master Timetable • DSA • Contests • Resources • Roadmap

CAREER DIRECTION

Primary: Cloud / DevOps / Platform Engineering. Secondary: Backend / SDE. ML is intentionally excluded. The goal is to become employable by proving skills through hands-on work rather than collecting technologies.

Track	Weekly target	Priority	Evidence
GATE CSE	18–20 h	VERY HIGH	Notes + PYQs + mocks + error log
DSA	8–10 h	HIGH	Striver A2Z + independent solutions + contests
Cloud / DevOps	8–10 h	VERY HIGH	Labs + GitHub repo + deployable project
College	As required	HIGH	Assignments, labs, CGPA
Rest / sleep	7.5–8 h sleep	NON-NEGOTIABLE	Sustainable weekly execution

1. Important Correction: Your Actual College Timetable

The previous version incorrectly placed classes on several days. This version uses the green-highlighted slots in the timetable image as your actual enrolled classes. Yellow slots are treated as free periods. A minimum 15-minute commute is included before the first campus class and after the last campus class.

Your actual enrolled class blocks from the supplied timetable:

Day	Time	Class	Type
Monday	15:50–16:40	D2 – BCSE305L-TH-AB3-603-ALL	Theory
Monday	16:45–17:35	TB2 – BCSE301L-TH-AB3-404-ALL	Theory
Tuesday	14:00–14:50	B2 – BCSE301L-TH-AB3-404-ALL	Theory
Tuesday	15:50–16:40	E2 – BCSE432E-ETH-MAB3-201-ALL	Theory
Wednesday	08:00–09:40	L13 + L14 – BCSE432E-ELA-AB1-506A-ALL	Lab
Wednesday	14:00–14:50	C2 – BCSE428L-TH-MAB3-201-ALL	Theory
Wednesday	16:45–17:35	TD2 – BCSE305L-TH-AB3-603-ALL	Theory
Thursday	14:00–14:50	D2 – BCSE305L-TH-AB3-603-ALL	Theory
Thursday	14:55–15:45	B2 – BCSE301L-TH-AB3-404-ALL	Theory
Thursday	16:45–17:35	TE2 – BCSE432E-ETH-MAB3-201-ALL	Theory
Friday	08:00–09:40	L25 + L26 – BCSE428P-LO-AB3-710-ALL	Lab
Friday	14:00–14:50	E2 – BCSE432E-ETH-MAB3-201-ALL	Theory
Friday	14:55–15:45	C2 – BCSE428L-TH-MAB3-201-ALL	Theory

NO COLLEGE CLASSES SHOWN IN GREEN

Saturday and Sunday have no green enrolled theory/lab cells in the supplied timetable, so they are treated as study/recovery days.

2. Corrected Weekly Timetable

This is the timetable to actually follow. Do not move a study block into a class block. When there is a long gap between classes, use campus time for assignments, light revision or rest rather than pretending it is a deep-work session.

MON

Time	Activity	Category
07:00–07:30	Wake + hygiene	REST
07:30–08:00	Breakfast	REST
08:00–10:00	GATE — main concept study	GATE
10:00–10:30	Break	REST
10:30–12:00	DSA — Striver A2Z	DSA
12:00–12:45	Lunch	REST
12:45–14:15	Cloud / DevOps hands-on	CLOUD
14:15–15:00	Rest / get ready	REST
15:00–15:35	Free / early travel buffer	REST
15:35–15:50	Travel to college	TRAVEL
15:50–16:40	D2 – BCSE305L	CLASS
16:45–17:35	TB2 – BCSE301L	CLASS
17:35–17:50	Travel home	TRAVEL
18:00–19:00	Dinner + decompression	REST
19:00–20:30	GATE PYQs / revision	GATE
20:30–21:00	Break	REST
21:00–22:00	DSA problems / review	DSA
22:00–23:00	Free time / wind down	REST
23:00–07:00	Sleep	SLEEP

TUE

Time	Activity	Category
07:00–07:30	Wake + hygiene	REST
07:30–08:00	Breakfast	REST
08:00–10:00	GATE — main concept study	GATE
10:00–10:30	Break	REST
10:30–12:00	DSA — Striver A2Z	DSA
12:00–12:45	Lunch	REST
12:45–13:30	Cloud / DevOps theory or lab	CLOUD
13:30–13:45	Get ready	REST
13:45–14:00	Travel to college	TRAVEL
14:00–14:50	B2 – BCSE301L	CLASS
14:50–15:35	Campus gap — assignment / rest	COLLEGE
15:35–15:50	Prepare / move to class	COLLEGE
15:50–16:40	E2 – BCSE432E	CLASS
16:40–16:55	Travel home	TRAVEL
17:00–18:00	Proper rest / walk	REST
18:00–19:00	Dinner	REST
19:00–20:30	GATE PYQs	GATE
20:30–21:00	Break	REST
21:00–22:00	DSA problems	DSA
22:00–23:00	Free time / wind down	REST
23:00–07:00	Sleep	SLEEP

WED

Time	Activity	Category
06:30–07:00	Wake + hygiene	REST
07:00–07:20	Breakfast	REST
07:20–07:45	Travel to college	TRAVEL
08:00–09:40	L13 + L14 – BCSE432E LAB	CLASS
09:40–09:55	Travel home	TRAVEL
10:00–10:30	Break	REST
10:30–12:00	GATE	GATE
12:00–12:45	Lunch	REST
12:45–13:30	DSA	DSA
13:30–13:45	Get ready	REST
13:45–14:00	Travel to college	TRAVEL
14:00–14:50	C2 – BCSE428L	CLASS
14:50–16:30	Campus gap — assignment / revision / rest	COLLEGE
16:30–16:45	Move to class	COLLEGE

16:45–17:35	TD2 – BCSE305L	CLASS
17:35–17:50	Travel home	TRAVEL
18:00–19:00	Dinner + rest	REST
19:00–20:00	DSA warm-up / contest prep	DSA
20:00–22:00	CodeChef Starters — weekly contest	CONTEST
22:00–22:30	Contest notes / cool-down	REST
22:30–23:00	Wind down	REST
23:00–06:30	Sleep	SLEEP

THU

Time	Activity	Category
07:00–07:30	Wake + hygiene	REST
07:30–08:00	Breakfast	REST
08:00–10:00	GATE — main study	GATE
10:00–10:30	Break	REST
10:30–12:00	DSA — Striver A2Z	DSA
12:00–12:45	Lunch	REST
12:45–13:30	Cloud / DevOps	CLOUD
13:30–13:45	Get ready	REST
13:45–14:00	Travel to college	TRAVEL
14:00–14:50	D2 – BCSE305L	CLASS
14:55–15:45	B2 – BCSE301L	CLASS
15:45–16:30	Campus gap — assignment / revision	COLLEGE
16:30–16:45	Move to class	COLLEGE
16:45–17:35	TE2 – BCSE432E	CLASS
17:35–17:50	Travel home	TRAVEL
18:00–19:00	Rest + dinner	REST
19:00–20:30	Cloud / DevOps hands-on	CLOUD
20:30–21:00	Break	REST
21:00–22:00	GATE PYQs	GATE
22:00–23:00	Free time	REST
23:00–07:00	Sleep	SLEEP

FRI

Time	Activity	Category
06:30–07:00	Wake + hygiene	REST
07:00–07:20	Breakfast	REST
07:20–07:45	Travel to college	TRAVEL
08:00–09:40	L25 + L26 – BCSE428P LAB	CLASS
09:40–09:55	Travel home	TRAVEL
10:00–11:30	GATE	GATE
11:30–12:00	Break	REST
12:00–12:45	DSA	DSA
12:45–13:15	Lunch	REST
13:15–13:45	Rest / get ready	REST
13:45–14:00	Travel to college	TRAVEL
14:00–14:50	E2 – BCSE432E	CLASS
14:55–15:45	C2 – BCSE428L	CLASS
15:45–16:00	Travel home	TRAVEL
16:00–17:00	Proper rest	REST
17:00–18:30	Cloud / DevOps hands-on	CLOUD
18:30–19:30	Dinner	REST
19:30–21:00	GATE PYQs / weekly revision	GATE
21:00–23:00	Relax / social / hobby	REST
23:00–07:30	Sleep	SLEEP

SAT

Time	Activity	Category
07:30–08:00	Wake + hygiene	REST
08:00–08:30	Breakfast	REST
08:30–11:00	GATE — deep study	GATE
11:00–11:30	Break	REST
11:30–13:00	DSA — Striver A2Z	DSA
13:00–14:00	Lunch	REST
14:00–15:00	Rest / nap / walk	REST
15:00–18:00	Cloud / DevOps hands-on project	CLOUD
18:00–19:00	Break / personal time	REST

19:00–19:45	Dinner	REST
20:00–21:30	LeetCode Biweekly — alternate Saturdays	CONTEST
21:30–22:30	Upsolve / contest notes	DSA
22:30–23:30	Free time	REST
23:30–07:30	Sleep	SLEEP

SUN

Time	Activity	Category
07:15–07:30	Wake + hygiene	REST
07:30–07:50	Breakfast	REST
08:00–09:30	LeetCode Weekly Contest	CONTEST
09:30–10:00	Break	REST
10:00–12:00	GATE revision / PYQs	GATE
12:00–12:30	Break	REST
12:30–13:30	DSA upsolve / contest review	DSA
13:30–14:30	Lunch	REST
14:30–15:00	Rest	REST
15:00–17:00	GATE mock / full PYQ session	GATE
17:00–18:00	Break	REST
18:00–19:00	Analyze GATE mistakes	GATE
19:00–20:00	Dinner	REST
20:00–21:00	Weekly review + next-week plan	REVIEW
21:00–23:00	Completely free	REST
23:00–07:00	Sleep	SLEEP

3. DSA Competition Schedule & Priority

Contests are part of the DSA plan, not additional work. Do them independently, then upsolve. LeetCode itself recommends regular weekly/biweekly participation for interview readiness, and its contest rules prohibit external assistance/code-generation tools during contests.

Contest	Cadence	Typical slot (IST)	Duration	Priority	Timetable treatment	Purpose
LeetCode Weekly	Every Sunday	08:00–09:30 IST	90 min	HIGH	Replace Sunday morning DSA block	Timed interview practice; upsolve after
LeetCode Biweekly	Every other Saturday	20:00–21:30 IST	90 min	HIGH	Replace Saturday evening DSA block	Second timed assessment every 2 weeks
CodeChef Starters	Every Wednesday	20:00–22:00 IST	2 h	HIGH	Replace Wednesday evening DSA block	Competitive programming + speed
CodeChef DSAMONDAY	Every Monday	Check live contest calendar	Varies	MEDIUM	Optional; do not displace GATE	Classical DSA challenge

CURRENT SCHEDULE CHECK

The live contest listings currently show CodeChef Starters on Wednesdays and DSAMONDAY as a Monday series. LeetCode currently has Biweekly Contest 191 on Saturday 12 Sep 2026 and Weekly Contest 519 on Sunday 13 Sep 2026. Exact dates can shift, so check the platform calendar before each contest.

Contest Rules

- No AI, ChatGPT, editorials, solution lookup or external code generation during the contest.
- Attempt every problem you reasonably can before moving on; do not spend the whole contest on one problem.
- After the contest, record: solved independently, partial, or needed solution.
- Within 24 hours, upsolve at least one missed problem.
- Re-solve important failed problems 2–7 days later.
- Once a month, review rating, solve count, accuracy and time-management problems.

4. What to Focus On — Priority Matrix

Area	Priority	Time target	Success condition	Rule
GATE CSE	Very High	18–20 h/week	Complete syllabus → PYQs → mocks → error log	Do not sacrifice repeatedly for projects
Linux	Very High	2–3 h/week initially	CLI, processes, services, permissions, SSH, logs	Must be usable without AI
Networking	Very High	2–3 h/week initially	IP/CIDR, DNS, TCP/UDP, HTTP, NAT, routing	Core for both GATE + Cloud
DSA	High	8–10 h/week	Striver A2Z + contests	Independent solving is the metric
Docker	High	2–3 h/week in Oct	Images, containers, Compose, networking, volumes	Build real containers
Git/GitHub Actions	High	2 h/week in Oct	CI, tests, build, registry	Be able to rebuild pipeline
Azure	High	2–3 h/week Oct–Nov	Compute, networking, storage, identity, monitoring	Deploy something real
Kubernetes	Medium-High	2–3 h/week Nov–Dec	Pods, Deployments, Services, Ingress, probes	Only after Docker
Terraform	Medium	2 h/week Dec	Resources, variables, state, plan/apply	Only after Azure basics
Observability	Medium	1–2 h/week Dec–Jan	Logs, metrics, health, alerts	Use in flagship project
Backend / SDE	Secondary	1–2 h/week via project	FastAPI/SQL/API fundamentals	Keep open without becoming a second full roadmap
Certificates	Low	Only if useful	Prefer proof through projects	Never replace hands-on learning
ML	None	0 h/week	Excluded	Do not spend time here

5. Free / Primary Learning Resources

Use one primary resource per topic. Do not collect playlists. The resource stack below is intentionally small so your time goes into practice.

Track	Resource	Best for	How to use	Link
DSA	Striver / Take U Forward — A2Z	Primary DSA roadmap	Solve; do not passively watch.	https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/
Linux	Linux Journey	CLI, filesystem, processes, permissions	Run everything yourself on Linux.	https://linuxjourney.com/
Networking	Neso Academy — Computer Networks	GATE + Cloud networking	Lecture → notes → PYQs/labs.	https://www.youtube.com/@nesoacademy
Docker	Docker Get Started	Images, containers, Compose	Build and run containers while learning.	https://docs.docker.com/get-started/
Git / CI	GitHub Skills	GitHub Actions + workflows	Use interactive exercises.	https://skills.github.com/
Azure	Microsoft Learn — Azure	Cloud fundamentals	Complete beginner paths first.	https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/azure/
Kubernetes	Kubernetes Official Tutorials	Pods, Deployments, Services, debugging	Start after Docker is comfortable.	https://kubernetes.io/docs/tutorials/
Terraform	HashiCorp Learn / Tutorials	IaC + Azure	Learn init/plan/apply/state.	https://developer.hashicorp.com/terraform/tutorials
GATE	IIT Madras GATE 2027	Official syllabus, dates, pattern	Authority for examinable content.	https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in/
GATE	NPTEL GATE Portal	Lectures, PYQs, mocks	Use selectively as needed.	https://gate.nptel.ac.in/
CodeChef	CodeChef Learn	Topic-based DSA/CP learning	Use for weak contest topics.	https://www.codechef.com/learn
LeetCode	LeetCode Contests	Weekly/biweekly contests	Independent timed practice.	https://leetcode.com/contest/

Resource Rule

- If Striver A2Z says arrays, do arrays. Do not open three other DSA sheets.
- If a Linux concept is unclear, use Linux Journey + your own terminal.
- For GATE, the IIT Madras syllabus is the authority; old checklists are secondary.
- For Cloud, official documentation is the final reference when tutorials disagree.
- For every Cloud topic, produce something: command notes, configuration, deployment, troubleshooting note or code.

6. DSA Roadmap — Striver A2Z

Phase	Topics	Weekly focus	Completion test
1. Foundations	Complexity, basic maths, recursion, sorting	6–8 h	Explain Big-O and implement common sorts
2. Arrays / Hashing	Arrays, hashing, two pointers, sliding window, binary search	8–10 h	Solve common easy/medium patterns independently
3. Linked Lists	Singly/doubly LL, fast/slow pointers, reversal	6–8 h	Explain pointer changes
4. Stack / Queue	Stack, queue, monotonic structures	5–7 h	Recognize stack/queue patterns
5. Trees / Heaps	Trees, BST, traversals, heaps, priority queues	8–10 h	Implement DFS/BFS + heap operations
6. Graphs	BFS, DFS, shortest paths, MST, DSU	10–12 h	Choose the correct graph algorithm
7. Greedy / DP	Greedy, 1D/2D DP, subsequences, grids	10–12 h	State + transition + base case + order
8. Interview revision	Mixed patterns + timed sets	8 h	Solve mixed questions under time pressure

DSA Session Template

Block	Time	Action
Concept	20 min	Learn only enough to understand the pattern
Problems	50 min	Attempt independently with a timer
Review	20 min	Write failure, key idea and complexity
Recall	5 min	Close everything and explain aloud

AI Rule for DSA

- Try for at least 20–30 minutes.
- If stuck, ask for one hint, not the full answer.
- If still stuck, ask for the next hint.
- After seeing a solution, close it and implement from memory.
- Re-solve the same problem 2–7 days later.

7. Cloud / DevOps Roadmap

Month	Primary topics	Hands-on output	Do not move on until
Sep 2026	Linux + networking	CLI, SSH, processes, services, curl, ss, DNS	Troubleshoot a Linux service without AI
Oct 2026	Docker + GitHub Actions + Azure fundamentals	Dockerfile, Compose, CI pipeline, first Azure deployment	Rebuild your pipeline and explain it
Nov 2026	Azure deeper + Kubernetes	Deploy, expose and debug a container	Understand Pods, Deployments, Services, Ingress, probes
Dec 2026	Kubernetes + Terraform + observability	IaC, state, deployment manifests, logs/metrics	Provision basic infrastructure and explain state
Jan 2027	Production-style project	Monitoring, health checks, documentation, troubleshooting	Clone → build → deploy → monitor from README
Feb 2027	Maintenance during GATE	Project/interview prep only when GATE permits	Keep project alive; no major new technology

Detailed Skill Checklist

Area	Checklist
Linux	filesystem; permissions; users/groups; processes; signals; systemd; journalctl; SSH; env vars; pipes; grep; awk; sed; curl; ss; df; free; top; cron; logs
Networking	IPv4; subnetting; CIDR; ports; TCP vs UDP; DNS; HTTP/HTTPS; TLS basics; NAT; routing; reverse proxy; load balancing; firewall/security groups
Docker	Dockerfile; images; layers; containers; port mapping; volumes; networks; Compose; registry; multi-stage builds; health checks
CI/CD	triggers; jobs; runners; artifacts; secrets; env vars; tests; Docker build/push; deployment stages
Azure	resource groups; subscriptions; regions; VNets; subnets; NSGs; VMs; storage; Azure SQL; Key Vault; identity; ACR; App Service; AKS; Monitor
Kubernetes	Pod; Deployment; ReplicaSet; Service; Ingress; ConfigMap; Secret; Namespace; Volume; PVC; probes; resource requests/limits; rolling updates; HPA
Terraform	provider; resource; variables; outputs; modules; state; remote state; plan/apply/destroy
Observability	logs; metrics; traces conceptually; Prometheus; Grafana; Azure Monitor; alerts; health endpoints

8. GATE CSE Roadmap

Period	Subjects	Mode
Sep–Oct	Engineering Mathematics + Programming/Data Structures + Discrete Mathematics + Digital Logic	Concepts + topic PYQs
Oct–Nov	COA + Algorithms + Operating Systems + DBMS	Concepts + PYQs + short revision notes
Dec	Computer Networks + TOC + Compiler Design	Finish syllabus + PYQs
Jan	Full revision + PYQs + mocks	Error log + timed sets
Feb	Exam mode	Light revision, formulas, weak areas, sleep

GATE Priority Rule

PROTECTED TIME

GATE is the highest academic priority. Cloud/DevOps and DSA are important for your career, but if college workload or health causes overload, temporarily reduce Cloud/DSA volume before repeatedly sacrificing GATE or sleep.

GATE Subject Checklist

Subject	Core coverage
Engineering Mathematics	Discrete Mathematics, Linear Algebra, Calculus, Probability & Statistics
Digital Logic	Boolean algebra, K-maps, combinational/sequential circuits, number representation
COA	ISA/addressing, ALU/control, memory hierarchy/cache, I/O, pipelining
Programming & Data Structures	C, recursion, arrays, stacks, queues, linked lists, trees, heaps, graphs
Algorithms	Searching, sorting, hashing, complexity, greedy, DP, divide-and-conquer, graph algorithms
TOC	Regular expressions/FA, CFG/PDA, pumping lemma, Turing machines
Compiler Design	Lexical analysis, parsing, translation, runtime, intermediate code, optimization/data-flow
Operating Systems	Processes, threads, IPC, synchronization, deadlocks, scheduling, memory, virtual memory, file systems
Databases	ER, relational algebra/calculus, SQL, constraints, normal forms, indexing, transactions/concurrency
Computer Networks	Layering, switching, data link, routing, IPv4/CIDR/NAT, TCP, sockets, DNS, HTTP

9. Month-by-Month Deliverables

Month	GATE	DSA	Cloud / DevOps	Deliverable
September	GATE: C + DS + Discrete	DSA: foundations, arrays, hashing, binary search, LL	Cloud: Linux + networking + Docker intro	Linux notes + 30–40 DSA problems + containerized small app
October	GATE: Algorithms + Digital Logic + COA	DSA: stacks, queues, recursion, trees, heaps	Cloud: Docker + GitHub Actions + Azure	CI pipeline + first Azure deployment
November	GATE: OS + DBMS	DSA: graphs	Cloud: Kubernetes	K8s deployment + expose + debug
December	GATE: CN + TOC + Compiler	DSA: greedy + DP + graph revision	Cloud: Terraform + observability	IaC + monitoring + health checks
January	GATE: full revision + mocks	DSA: mixed interview sets + contests	Cloud: flagship project hardening	Portfolio project + README + resume bullets
February	GATE: final revision + exam	DSA: maintenance	Cloud: maintenance	GATE + return to interviews/projects after exam

Flagship Project

Do not build another disconnected toy project. Take a software project you already understand and progressively turn it into a production-style cloud project.

Stage	Build	Skill	Evidence
1	Dockerize backend + DB	Docker, networking, volumes	Dockerfile + Compose
2	Automated tests	CI fundamentals	GitHub Actions workflow
3	Build/push image	Registry + CI/CD	Image in registry
4	Deploy to Azure	Cloud deployment	Live environment
5	Terraform infrastructure	IaC	main.tf / modules / state
6	Kubernetes deployment	Orchestration	Manifests / Helm
7	Monitoring	Logs / metrics / alerts	Dashboard + health endpoint
8	Documentation	Engineering communication	Architecture + runbook

10. How to Use AI Without Becoming Dependent

Situation	Bad use	Good use	Rule
DSA	Ask for complete code immediately	Ask for a hint about the pattern	20–30 min struggle first
Linux error	Paste error and copy command	Understand the error + inspect logs	Understand every command
Docker failure	Ask AI to rewrite Dockerfile	Read build output + inspect image/container/network	Fix one layer at a time
Kubernetes	Ask AI for YAML	Use describe/logs/events and form a hypothesis	Diagnose before changing
Terraform	Generate whole infrastructure	Write small resources + inspect plan	Never apply blindly
Interview	Memorize AI answers	Explain concepts aloud + whiteboard	If you cannot explain it, you don't know it

THE TEST

Close the AI/chat window and rebuild the thing from scratch. If you cannot, return to the concept and repeat it. This matters especially for DSA, Linux, Docker, Kubernetes and Terraform.

11. Resume Strategy

Direction	What to prove	Evidence
Docker / CI/CD	Docker + GitHub Actions + registry + deployment	Show workflow files and explain every stage
Azure	Azure deployment + networking + monitoring	Show architecture and explain each service
DevOps	Linux + Docker + Kubernetes + Terraform	Show a reproducible project
SDE	DSA + backend + SQL + OS/DBMS/CN	Solve interview problems without AI
GATE	CSE fundamentals	PYQs + mocks + error log

DO NOT ADD YET

Do not put Kubernetes, Terraform, Azure, Prometheus, Grafana or other tools on your resume merely because they appear in this plan. Add them only after you can use and explain them independently.

12. Weekly Tracking Sheet

Record actual hours, not planned hours.

Day	GATE hours	DSA hours	Cloud hours	Notes / blockers
Mon	____	____	____	____
Tue	____	____	____	____
Wed	____	____	____	____
Thu	____	____	____	____
Fri	____	____	____	____
Sat	____	____	____	____
Sun	____	____	____	____
TOTAL	____	____	____	____

Sunday Review

- How many GATE hours did I actually complete?
- How many GATE PYQs did I solve?
- What was my weakest GATE topic?
- How many DSA problems did I solve independently?
- Did I participate in the scheduled contest(s)?
- What did I upsolve after the contest?
- What Cloud/DevOps hands-on task did I complete?
- Can I explain what I built without AI?
- What did I procrastinate on?
- What is the single most important task for next week?

Monthly Scorecard

Month	GATE h	DSA h	Cloud h	PYQs	DSA problems	Project milestone
Sep 2026	____	____	____	____	____	____
Oct 2026	____	____	____	____	____	____
Nov 2026	____	____	____	____	____	____
Dec 2026	____	____	____	____	____	____
Jan 2027	____	____	____	____	____	____
Feb 2027	____	____	____	____	____	____

13. Start Here — Next 7 Days

Day	GATE	DSA	Cloud	Done
Day 1	GATE: C basics + Big-O	DSA: A2Z basics	Linux: filesystem + commands	☐
Day 2	GATE: Discrete maths	DSA: arrays	Linux: permissions + users	☐
Day 3	GATE: C pointers / recursion	DSA: array problems	Linux: processes + ps/top	☐
Day 4	GATE: Data structures	DSA: hashing + two pointers	Linux: systemctl + journalctl	☐
Day 5	GATE: DS PYQs	DSA: binary search	Linux: SSH + curl + ss	☐
Day 6	GATE: PYQ set	DSA: mixed arrays	Networking: IP/TCP/UDP/DNS	☐
Day 7	Mini test + review	Re-solve failures	Docker introduction	☐

14. Operating Principles

THE PLAN IN ONE LINE

GATE every day, DSA almost every day, one or more coding contests every week, Cloud hands-on several times a week, one serious portfolio project, no ML track, and enough sleep to repeat the process for months.

- If college workload spikes, reduce Cloud/DSA temporarily before sacrificing sleep or abandoning GATE completely.
- If you miss one day, resume the next scheduled block. Do not try to make up the entire day at once.
- Every study session should end with something you can demonstrate: solved problems, notes, commands, code, deployment or troubleshooting.
- Your resume should lag behind your skills, not lead them.

15. Quick Resource Index

- **GATE 2027 official home:** https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in/
- **GATE 2027 important dates:** https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in/important_dates
- **GATE 2027 CS syllabus:** https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in/cs
- **Striver A2Z DSA:** https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/
- **LeetCode contests:** https://leetcode.com/contest/
- **CodeChef contests:** https://www.codechef.com/contests
- **CodeChef Learn:** https://www.codechef.com/learn
- **Linux Journey:** https://linuxjourney.com/
- **Docker Get Started:** https://docs.docker.com/get-started/
- **GitHub Skills:** https://skills.github.com/
- **Microsoft Learn Azure:** https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/azure/
- **Kubernetes tutorials:** https://kubernetes.io/docs/tutorials/
- **Terraform tutorials:** https://developer.hashicorp.com/terraform/tutorials
- **NPTEL GATE:** https://gate.nptel.ac.in/